

PUMP up The VOLUME!

Whether road warrior or daily commuter, your journey just isn't complete without a good dose of music—to soothe your soul, bust stress and relax your nerves. We've got 46 faithful companions, just waiting to take that dusty, noisy ride with you...

Imaging Rohit A Chandwaskar
Photograph Jiten Gandhi & Sandeep Patil



Michael Browne

Silence speaks a thousand words. Poetic but true, though the sheer amount of noise pollution these days means you may well need some silence to hear anything, or be heard yourself. If you're a metropolitan who spends a couple of hours commuting to work, you'll probably lament the lack of time spent with loved ones. To make things worse, the couple of hours of *mandatory* travel are marred by all kinds of pollution. Short of scrapping hydrocarbon-spewing automobiles totally, there's nothing that can be done about air pollution, but what about

all the honking around you, or the din made by fellow travellers aboard your daily 9.30 am local train?

For many of us, the Portable Multimedia Player (PMP) is a blessing sans disguise. The next time you're travelling, just ask anybody with earplugs stuck in his ears what it means to him. Music soothes, relaxes, and is akin to the daily morning cup of fresh tea. To further testify the popularity of PMPs, just visit any electronics store—chances are you'll see many such devices—they sell like hot cakes these days. Not only are they immensely functional, but whip out an iPod and a couple of people around you will surely perk up. Add to

that the fact that no cell phone can approach the kind of multimedia functionality (camera aside) that a PMP will give you. PMPs in general have bigger, better screens and better music playback quality—that alone is enough to ensure a steady demand from more discerning users.

A PMP is as personal a device as a cell phone or headphones, and no two people will have the same requirements. While someone may want to watch videos in bed, another may need something with exemplary music quality to use as a portable source. Someone else may need a basic player to tune in to music en route to their workplace. PMP vendors